



HTTP status codes reference

LearnHub course reference: ASP.NET Core MVC in Practice

Every HTTP response starts with a three-digit status code. The first digit tells the browser what kind of result it is: **2xx** success, **3xx** redirection, **4xx** a problem with the request, **5xx** a problem on the server.

Code	Name	What it means	In ASP.NET Core
200	OK	The request worked and the response contains the page or data.	<code>return View(model);</code>
201	Created	A new resource was created, usually by an API POST request.	<code>return Created(url, item);</code>
204	No Content	Success with nothing to return, for example after a delete in an API.	<code>return NoContent();</code>
301	Moved Permanently	The page has a new permanent address; browsers and search engines update links.	<code>RedirectPermanent(url)</code>
302	Found	Temporary redirect, used after a successful form post (Post/Redirect/Get).	<code>RedirectToAction(...)</code>
304	Not Modified	The browser's cached copy is still valid, so nothing is downloaded again.	Static files middleware
400	Bad Request	The request is malformed, for example a missing anti-forgery token.	<code>return BadRequest();</code>
401	Unauthorized	The user is not signed in. Cookie authentication redirects to the login page instead.	<code>Challenge()</code>
403	Forbidden	The user is signed in but lacks permission, such as a student opening an admin page.	<code>[Authorize(Roles = "Admin")]</code>
404	Not Found	No page or record exists at this address. Also used to hide records a user may not see.	<code>return NotFound();</code>
405	Method Not Allowed	The address exists but not for this HTTP method, such as GET on a POST-only action.	<code>[HttpPost]</code>
409	Conflict	The request conflicts with the current state, for example a duplicate record.	<code>return Conflict();</code>
422	Unprocessable Content	The data is well-formed but fails validation (common in APIs).	<code>UnprocessableEntity()</code>
429	Too Many Requests	The client sent too many requests in a short time and must wait.	Rate limiting middleware
500	Internal Server Error	An unhandled exception occurred. Users should see a friendly error page, never a stack trace.	<code>UseExceptionHandler("/Error")</code>
502	Bad Gateway	A proxy in front of the app received an invalid response, often while the app is starting.	Hosting platform

503

Service Unavailable

The server is temporarily overloaded or
down for maintenance.Hosting platform

Good practice

- After a successful form post, redirect (302) instead of returning a page, so refreshing does not submit the form twice.
- Return 404 rather than 403 when revealing that a private record exists would itself leak information.
- Show friendly pages for 404 and 500 with `UseStatusCodePagesWithReExecute` and `ExceptionHandler`.

LearnHub course reference. Status code names follow RFC 9110.